# Seeing How Many Without Counting

## Answer Key

Kindergarten–Grade 1

**Quick Answers**

| | | | |
|---|---|---|---|
| 1. 3 | 3. 4 | 5. 4 | 7. — |
| 2. 5 | 4. 2 | 6. 5 | 8. — |

**How to use this key.** Each solution names the *pattern* the child should see, not a counting sequence. If a child counts one-by-one and gets the right number, the answer is correct but the target skill is not yet there — flash the card for about two seconds and ask again.

**1.** Dot card: three dots on a slanted line (the domino/dice three).
**Solution:** The three dots sit in the familiar slanted-line pattern. A child who knows this pattern says "three" with no counting; the dots do not need to be touched one at a time. Written as a number, the card shows $\boxed{3}$.

**2.** Dot card: four dots in the corners with one dot in the middle (the dice five).
**Solution:** This is the dice five: a square of four with one in the centre. Seeing it as "four corners and a middle" is what makes it instant. The card shows $\boxed{5}$.

**3.** Five-frame with one empty box.
**Solution:** A five-frame is full at five, so read the *empty* boxes instead of the dots. One box is empty, and one less than five is four: $5 - 1 = 4$. The frame shows $\boxed{4}$.

**4.** Five-frame with three empty boxes.
**Solution:** Three boxes are empty, so the frame is three away from full: $5 - 3 = 2$. The frame shows $\boxed{2}$.

**5.** Two cards, each showing a pair of dots.
**Solution:** Each card is a pair, and a pair is seen at a glance as two. Two and two more is four: $2 + 2 = 4$. Altogether the cards show $\boxed{4}$.

**6.** One card showing a slanted three, one card showing a pair.
**Solution:** The left card is the slanted three, the right card is a pair. Hold three in your head and count on two: four, five. As a number sentence, $3 + 2 = 5$, so the cards show $\boxed{5}$.

**7.** Left card: four dots in a square. Right card: three dots on a slant.
**Solution:** The square pattern is four; the slanted line is three. Four is more than three, so the left card wins and the symbol points at the smaller number: $\boxed{>}$.

**8.** Left card: two groups of two. Right card: a full five-frame.
**Solution:** The left card is a pair and another pair, which is $2 + 2 = 4$. The right frame is full, and full means five. Four is less than five, so the correct symbol is $\boxed{<}$. This is the one problem where the bigger-looking card (two separate boxes) holds fewer dots — the child must finish both readings before choosing.